



PATTERNS & COMPONENTS

DOC NO. RL-BRAND-001-PAT-A REV. A RIPOSTE LABORATORIES

Every class here ships in `brand/riposte-brand.css`, reads semantic variables, and survives `.dark` / `.pinkfield` inversion without extra work. Class names match the production site's markup – this is documentation of a real system, not a proposal.

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See it all rendered: `specimen/index.html`.

SEC.01

1 • THE THREE SIGNATURE PATTERNS

The mi-parti kit. All three are **hard-stop gradients** — no blending, ever.

CHECKER BAND — `.checker`

22px conic tiles · 26px band height (tile + 2 × 2px rule) · ink/bone

`.checker.teal` swaps ink for teal. On a dark field it auto-swaps to teal-on-ink.

HARLEQUIN BAND — `.harlequin`

34px diamonds (conic from 45deg) · 38px band height · pink/teal

TRI-BAND — `-triband`

`linear-gradient(105deg, pink 0 36%, marigold 36% 64%, teal 64% 100%)`

Fills `.pagehead` banners and the right cell of `footer.colophon`.

RULES FOR ALL THREE

1. They are strips, never fields. 26px, 38px, and a footer cell. A full-page harlequin is a circus tent.
2. Alternate flavours down a page. Checker, then harlequin, then checker. Two identical bands in a row reads as a rendering bug.
3. One flavour per page maximum for the tri-band — it's the pagehead, and repeating it demotes the page head.
4. `aria-hidden="true"`. They are decoration.

SEC.02

2 • DOCUMENT CHROME

The spec-sheet layer. This is what makes a page read as a filed document.

CLASS	WHAT IT IS
<code>.pagehead + .kicker</code>	Tri-band banner: kicker, h1, optional 62ch strapline
<code>.sechead</code>	SEC.NN chip + uppercase h2 + right-aligned // slash tag, over a 2px rule
<code>.corner (.tl .tr .bl .br)</code> inside <code>.cornered</code>	Corner marks: DOC NO. RL-000-A, REV. A
<code>.slashtag</code>	The lowercase code-comment annotation, .14em tracked, 60% opacity
<code>.stamp</code>	Rotated -2deg marigold outline stamp – DRAFT, ILLUSTRATIVE

SEC.NN chips rotate their fill: `.pinkno`, `.orangen`, `.tealno`, or the default ink. Number sections in order and let the colour cycle follow.

Chrome is decorative. Mark SEC.NN and corner marks `aria-hidden="true"` so the heading announces as its title.

SEC.03

3 • CARDS

`.spec` – THE WORKHORSE

Header row (uppercase, .16em tracked, on bone-dim) over a ▶-bulleted body with dashed row dividers. Header fill variants: `.orangehead`, `.tealhead`, `.inkhead`.

.verdict – YES / NO / WARN

Same anatomy, but the header is a full accent fill and the bullets carry meaning:

VARIANT	HEADER	BULLET
.yes	teal	✓
.no	pink	×
.warn	marigold	!

Pair the glyphs with visually-hidden text – see [07-accessibility.md](#) RL-BRAND-001-A11Y.

.partner – ROTATING MASTHEAD

A bordered card whose 6px top bar cycles pink → marigold → teal → ink on `nth-child(4n)`. The ink beat is what stops the rotation reading as a rainbow.

.stat – THE NUMBER

Large 800-weight figure (`clamp(26px, 4vw, 44px), -.02em`) over an uppercase label. `.n.pink` / `.n.orange` / `.n.teal` colour the figure – and at that size the bright accents clear the AA-Large threshold, so this is one of the few places accent-coloured text is legal.

SEC.04

4 • CALLOUTS

CLASS	SPINE	USE
.note	8px marigold left bar, on bone-dim	Asides, caveats, warnings. Marigold because ink on marigold is 8.12:1 – the callout people actually have to read.
.pull	8px pink left bar, no box	Pull quotes. 700, 60ch max.

SEC.05

5 • FLOW

.flow > .step – bordered process steps joined by → arrows sitting in a 26px right margin. Top bars rotate on the 4-cycle. Below 640px the steps stack and the arrow rotates to ↓.

This is the **only** off-scale spacing value in the system, and it's off-scale because a glyph has to fit in the gap. See 03-spacing.md_{RL-BRAND-001-SPACE}.

The canonical Riposte flow is the fencing frame: **parry → riposte → return.**

SEC.06

6 • SMALL ELEMENTS

CLASS	ANATOMY
<code>.chip</code>	10px uppercase, <code>.12em</code> , 3px 9px, 2px border. <code>.pink</code> <code>.orange</code> <code>.teal</code> <code>.ink</code>
<code>.pill</code>	12px uppercase, 2px border, 7px 12px. Larger, quieter
<code>.pills</code>	Flex wrapper, 8px gap
<code>.marquee</code>	Ink ticker, <code>.18em</code> , 28s linear loop. <code>.c1/.c2/.c3</code> colour the words

SEC.07

7 • ACTIONS

CLASS	BEHAVIOUR
<code>.cta</code>	Outline button. Hover: invert + <code>translate(-2px,-2px)</code> + 4px 4px 0 pink
<code>.bigmail</code>	Full-width block CTA. Hover: ink fill + 8px 8px 0 teal, 16px 16px 0 pink
<code>button</code> / <code>.btn</code>	Same as <code>.cta</code> , applied to real buttons

The hover grammar, everywhere in the system: move up-left 2px, drop a hard off-set shadow in an accent, invert the fill. No blur, no scale, no opacity fade.

The `--shadow-stack` double-offset is for **big CTAs only**. On a small button it reads as a mistake.

SEC.08

8 • THE COLOPHON FOOTER

HTML

```
<footer class="colophon">
  <div class="l">&copy; 2026 Riposte Laboratories Inc. &middot; All rights reserved.</div>
  <div class="r">parry &#9851; riposte &#9851; recycle &#9851; repeat</div>
</footer>
```

Ink cell left, tri-band cell right, 2px ink rule above, 11px uppercase .1em. Collapses to one column below 560px.

This is the standard close for every Riposte page. Same two cells, same order, every time. It's the signature at the bottom of the document.

SEC.09

9 • DIAGRAMS

Hand-built SVG line diagrams in brand colours on the current field – the HEX unit, the tessellation, the dome. Labelled in mono like an instrument faceplate.

- ▶ Stroke weights match the CSS rules: 2px structural, 1px dashed for construction lines
- ▶ -teal-deep for linework on teal, -teal-ink for labels on teal fills
- ▶ Labels uppercase, -text-label (11px), .1em tracked
- ▶ No fills except flat brand colours. No gradients, no soft shading
- ▶currentColor wherever possible, so the diagram inverts with its field

No icon fonts and no icon sets. Anything that looks like an icon is either a glyph (see 02-typography.md_{RL-BRAND-001-TYPE}) or a hand-drawn SVG.

CHARTS

Bordered boxes with flat accent fills – no axes lines beyond the structural rule, no gridlines, no drop shadows.

Need more than three categories? Do not add a fourth accent. In order:

1. Rotate the three accents and add the **ink** beat – four series.
2. Add **bone-dim** fill with a **2px** ink border – five.
3. Add the **-deep** variants – eight, and still on-brand.
4. Beyond that, the chart is wrong. Split it, or use a table.

SEC.10

10 • MOTION

```
120ms --dur-flick    colour swaps: nav, links, chips
150ms --dur-snap     pops: CTA hover, arrow slide, caret rotate
250ms --dur-move     progress bars, larger repositions
28s   --marquee-dur  ticker loop, linear
```

Plain easing. Hover = invert or accent fill. Arrows slide in from **-5px**. Carets rotate.

No scroll-triggered fades. No parallax. No entrance animations. A Riposte page is already there when you arrive – it's a printed document, not a presentation.

The one canvas moment: layered signal-wave sines in the three accents behind the hero mark.

SEC.11

11 • LAYOUT HELPERS

CSS

```
.wrap          min(1060px, 100vw - 2×4vw)
.wrap-wide     min(1160px, ...)
.wrap-prose    min(900px, ...)
.section       padding-block: 64px
.grid          display:grid; gap:34px
.grid-2/3/4    columns at ≥760px
```

Prose helpers: `p.lead` (bold, 56ch), `.dim` (.65 opacity), `.hi` (bold + `-accent-text`), `.slashtag`.

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